EW 3 Past participle agreement with AVOIR verbs

17. **A verb in a COMPOUND TENSE is one which is made up of two parts**: the auxiliary [either *avoir* or *être*] and the past participle.

	Auxiliary		
PERFECT:	Present tense	*J'ai fait* *Je suis parti*	I have done/I have been doing/I did I have left/I left/ I did leave
PLUPERFECT:	Imperfect	*J'avais fait* *J'étais parti*	I had done/I had been doing I had left
FUTURE PERFECT:	Future	*J'aurai fait* *Je serai parti*	I will have done I will have left
CONDITIONAL PERFECT:	Conditional	*J'aurais fait* *Je serais parti*	I would have done I would have left

Examples: *Tiens! Il a neigé* — **Hey! It has been snowing**
Nous avons travaillé — **We have been working**

18. Past participle agreement with AVOIR verbs

The past participle will only change to agree with a direct object which comes in front of the verb: a PRECEDING DIRECT OBJECT (PDO)

There are 3 ways in which a direct object can come in front of the verb

i) **when COMBIEN DE or some form of QUEL is used**

— How many films did they see? *Combien de films ont-ils vus?*
— Which house did they rent? *Quelle maison ont-ils louée?*
— Which books have you chosen? *Quels livres avez-vous choisis?*

ii) **there is ALWAYS past participle agreement after QUE (QU')**

— *Elle aime les fromages QUE j'ai achetés* (s to agree with FROMAGES - masc. pl)
— *Voici la chambre QUE nous avons peinte* (e to agree with CHAMBRE - fem. sing.)
— *Regardez les chaussettes QU'il a mises* (es to agree with CHAUSSETTES - fem. pl.)

iii) **when the pronoun standing in front of the auxiliary is a direct object there is ALWAYS agreement with LA, L'(standing for LA) and LES**

— *A-t-elle remarqué la fenêtre cassée? Oui, elle l'a remarquée*
— *Avez-vous averti les parents? Oui, je les ai avertis (avertir qn* = to warn)

BUT with ME, TE, NOUS & VOUS there is only agreement if they are direct.
There is never agreement if they are indirect, i.e. if they are used with a verb that is followed by A QUELQU'UN rather than simply QUELQU'UN

Distinguish between :

	a)	*Il m'a punie', a répondu sa soeur*	*(punir quelqu'un)*
		Sa femme nous a accueillis	*(accueillir qn* = to welcome)
and	b)	*`Il ne m'a pas demandé pourquoi', a-t-elle dit*	*(demander à qn)*
		Il nous a donné des bonbons	*(donner qch à qn)*

NB If the verb uses AVOIR as an auxiliary the past participle NEVER agrees
- i) with the subject of the verb
- ii) with the pronoun EN (*il leur en a donné*)
- iii) with the pronouns LUI & LEUR (because they are indirect object pronouns which stand in place of A QUELQU'UN)

NB *il lui a donné des bonbons* BUT *il les lui a donnés* (**s** agrees with **les**, not with **lui**)

19. Verbs conjugated with ETRE

The following verbs are always conjugated with ETRE

aller	**:to go**	*rester*	**:to stay, remain**	*venir*	**:to come**
revenir	**:to come back**	*tomber*	**:to fall**	*devenir*	**:to become**
retourner	**:to go back, return**	*arriver*	**:to arrive**	*naître [né]*	**:to be born**
partir	**:to leave, set out**	*mourir [mort]*	**:to die**	*entrer*	**:to go to in** (+ DANS)

With the **following 4 verbs**, the auxiliary to be used will depend on the meaning : if they are used **INTRANSITIVELY** (i.e. without a direct object) they take ETRE; if **TRANSITIVELY** (i.e. with a direct object) they take AVOIR

i) *descendre* : to go/come down (INTRANS.) — to go/come down STHG (TRANS.) / to bring/take STHG down (TRANS.)
- *— Elle est descendue avant moi* **BUT** *Elle a descendu l'escalier (la valise)*

ii) *monter* : to go/come up (INTRANS.) — to go/come up STHG (TRANS.) / to bring/take STHG up (TRANS.)
- *— Nous sommes vite montés* **BUT** *Puis nous avons monté les bagages (l'escalier)*

iii) *rentrer* : to go/come home (INTRANS.) — to bring something in/put (car) in
- *— Elle est rentrée à pied* **BUT** *Elle a rentré la voiture*

iv) *sortir*: to go/come out (INTRANS.) — to take something out (TRANS.)
- *— Elle est sortie à huit heures* **BUT** *Elle a sorti son mouchoir*

20. Past participle agreement with ETRE verbs

The past participle of the verbs in 3 above ALWAYS agrees with the subject of the verb. (You will see in paragraph 23 on page 10 that this is not the case for reflexive verbs.)

She left:	*Elle est partie*	They had arrived	: *Ils étaient arrivés*
She was born	*Elle est née*	We stayed	: *Nous sommes restés*